ICT Intermarket Algorithm Operator's Manual

How to run the bot, talk to it from Telegram, place your buy-side / sell-side levels, and read the session handovers to time entries.

EURUSD - GBPUSD - NZDUSD	810 trades	45.9%	4.47	-12.95%

READ FIRST This manual describes the shipped strategy and the semi-auto Telegram controls. Everything you set is **optional and per-day**: leave it alone and the bot trades fully automatically, exactly as backtested. START ON A DEMO ACCOUNT.

Contents

1 - What the algorithm is

A fully-automated ICT (Inner Circle Trader) 2022 day-trading system for three FX pairs: **EURUSD, GBPUSD, NZDUSD**. It trades the **AMD cycle** (Accumulation → Manipulation → Distribution) during the London and New York killzones, gated by a three-layer intermarket model built on the US Dollar Index (DXY).

The core idea, in one sentence: **the market moves to liquidity.** Big players push price to where retail stop-losses rest (a sweep / "Judas swing"), fill their orders against that liquidity, then deliver price to the opposite pool. The bot is built to fade that sweep (reversal) or ride the confirmed break (continuation).

What you bring

The bot is complete on its own. The **semi-auto** layer lets you add your read of the day on top of it: the lot to use, which direction to hunt on a pair, the liquidity levels you're watching, and whether to let a trade run across sessions. Your inputs **filter and aim** the bot - they never override its risk rules or force a trade with no setup.

> **TIP** Everything in this manual is opt-in. If you send no commands, every pair trades fully automatically. The Telegram controls are there for the days you have a strong view.

2 - The trading day: sessions & killzones

The bot only looks for trades inside defined **killzones** - the windows when institutional flow is active. All times are **New York time (ET)**, which is what the engine uses internally.

London Open	02:00 - 05:00	EURUSD, GBPUSD, NZDUSD	Judas reversal home - the day's manipulation
NY AM	07:00 - 10:00	EURUSD, GBPUSD	Continuation / second delivery (NZD drains here)
NY noon block	12:00 - 13:00	none	Hard no-trade - lunchtime chop
NY PM	13:00 - 16:00	optional (off by default)	Position-squaring / mean-reversion

Each session is evaluated **independently** - a clean handover. London's read does not bleed into New York; when NY opens it starts a fresh AMD cycle. That separation is exactly what lets you treat the handover as its own trade setup (Section 7).

3 - The AMD cycle: the heartbeat of every trade

Every setup the bot takes is a phase of the same three-part cycle. Learn to see it and the rest of the manual clicks into place.

Accumulation	Asian / pre-session	Price coils in a tight range. Orders build. Volume is quiet.	The range that will be swept
Manipulation	Session open (the Judas)	Price spikes through one side of the range to grab stops, then snaps back.	The side that gets swept
Distribution	The real move	Price delivers in the opposite direction, toward the far liquidity pool.	The side it targets

KEY IDEA The Judas swing (manipulation) is the anchor. A sweep of one side that closes back inside the range is the bot's highest-conviction signal to trade the other way. Your **/levels** tell it which pools you expect to be swept and delivered to.

4 - How market structure is detected & traded

Structure is the skeleton the whole strategy hangs on - it says where the swing highs and lows are, which are still holding, and therefore which way price is really going. Here is how the bot finds them, and the key point: it **reads structure on the higher timeframe but takes the entry on the lower**.

The atomic unit - a 3-bar fractal

A swing is the simplest ICT pattern: a candle whose extreme is beyond the candle on **each** side.

```
Swing HIGH (STH) - middle bar's HIGH above BOTH neighbours:

b2
/ \ b2.High > b1.High AND b2.High > b3.High
b1 b3 -> b2 is a Short-Term High (STH)

Swing LOW (STL) - middle bar's LOW below BOTH neighbours:

b1 b3 b2.Low < b1.Low AND b2.Low < b3.Low
\ / -> b2 is a Short-Term Low (STL)
b2
```

Because a swing needs a candle on **each** side, it is only confirmed when the **third (right-side) bar** prints. The bot works off completed bars, so nothing repaints - and that third-bar rule is the whole key to the entry timing below.

The tiers are recursive, not wider lookbacks

The three ICT tiers are built by promoting the tier below - each is a fractal of the one under it:

STH / STL (short-term)	A 3-bar fractal on the raw candles.
ITH / ITL (intermediate)	A short-term high with a LOWER short-term high on each side (a fractal WITHIN the STH sequence). ITL is the inverse on STLs.
LTH / LTL (long-term)	An intermediate high with a lower intermediate high on each side - one tier up again.

Swept vs. intact - the level that still matters

After classifying, every swing is tagged: a high is **swept** once a later bar trades through it, a low once a later bar drops below it. The most recent **unswept** swing of a tier is the live reference - the level still holding. That one distinction drives the strategy:

- The **stop** sits beyond the intact intermediate swing (ITL for longs / ITH for shorts) - not the short-term swing, which gets run constantly.
- The **trend read** is the intermediate tier: higher ITLs = bullish, lower ITHs = bearish.
- **Judas vs. real break:** short-term swings getting taken while the ITH/ITL stays intact is a minor liquidity run (a Judas) - NOT a trend change. That double sweep is exactly what the bot fades.

The play: read structure HIGH, enter LOW

This is the heart of the entry. Structure is confirmed on the higher timeframe, but the entry is taken on the lower - so you are filled early, not waiting for a slow HTF candle to close.

- **1. Read the HTF.** On H4/H1 the draw cascade + fractal show the ITH/ITL is in place and an MSS (break of structure) has fired - you now know the bias and the draw (which way, and the pool price is headed for).
- **2. Anticipate the reversal swing on the LTF.** Drop to M5/M15 and wait for the counter-swing to form - an **STL** for a long (or **STH** for a short) at your entry zone (the FVG / OB).
- **3. Enter as that swing confirms.** The moment the LTF swing's **third bar** prints, the reversal is confirmed and price is already turning your way - you are in the move as it happens, stop just beyond the swing.

> **KEY IDEA** Because the LTF swing's third bar confirms in minutes, you do NOT wait for the higher-timeframe candle to close - by the time an H1/H4 candle would confirm the same swing, the move is long gone. The HTF gives the direction and the draw; the LTF 3-bar swing gives the early, precise entry.

In the engine this is literal: the HTF draw cascade (W/D/H4) sets the bias, the **MSS is checked on M15/M5**, entry is a limit into the M5/M15 FVG/OB, and the stop is anchored on the **M1** intact swing. The bot re-evaluates on **every M5 close** - so the LTF swing confirms and you are filled while the H1/H4 candle is still only part-formed.

5 - The intermarket gate: which pair, which way

Before any pair can trade, the dollar has to agree. This is a hard gate - no intermarket signal, no trade.

- **DXY (US Dollar Index)** sets USD direction on the H1 chart. If DXY is flat (no break of structure), every pair is skipped.
- **EURGBP** selects the EUR-vs-GBP family: it decides whether the cleaner short/long is on EURUSD or GBPUSD.
- **AUDNZD** selects the NZD family, routing to NZDUSD.

The result is a **scenario** (e.g. "DXY up + EUR stronger than GBP → short GBPUSD"). You don't need to memorise the scenarios - the bot classifies them - but it's why a `/bias` you set must still line up with a real intermarket signal to produce a trade.

6 - How the bot enters: the entry models

Model 1 - Judas reversal (the default)

- An M15 consolidation range must exist (both extremes tested).

- Price sweeps one extreme (the Judas swing) and closes back inside.
- 2-of-3 market-structure shifts confirm (EURUSD + GBPUSD + DXY inverse).
- Entry is a limit into an M5/M15/H1 fair-value gap (FVG) or order block (OB).
- Stop sits beyond the structural swing, capped tight (about 10 pips).

Model 2 - Intermarket breakout / continuation

The inverse of Judas: instead of fading a sweep, the bot rides a confirmed break. It requires **triple confirmation** - EURUSD and GBPUSD both break their M15 ranges in agreement AND DXY confirms with a break of structure. A single-pair break is treated as a fakeout and ignored. These continuations run **with** the higher-timeframe draw and are the natural NY-session trade.

> **NOTE** Reversal fades the sweep; breakout rides the break. The bot tags every trade as **judas** or **breakout** so you can see which model fired in the Telegram trade alert.

Model 3 - Market Maker IFVG model (watch or auto-enter)

A third, **opt-in** model you arm per pair from Telegram with **/mm**. It watches the higher timeframes for an **inversion fair-value gap (IFVG)** - a gap that price later closes a full body back through, flipping its polarity. That flip is a **Judas swing one timeframe up**: the level that repelled price now supports it, drawing price toward the same liquidity targets the bot already uses.

An FVG that gets a bullish full-body close back **above** it becomes a **demand (support)** zone; a bearish full-body close **below** makes a **supply (resistance)** zone. The bot scans **D1, H4 and H1** and keeps only the still-defended zones in your model's direction.

```
BUY model - a demand IFVG (support)

  a bearish gap forms as price drops through it, then price
  RETURNS and closes a full body back ABOVE it -> the gap
  inverts into a DEMAND zone that now holds price up.

     1.15470  +-----------------+  zone top
              |  DEMAND  IFVG  |
     1.15400  +-----------------+  zone bottom
```

The three beats - what to do, and when

In **/read** and **/brief** each armed zone shows how far price is (pips + % of the way from where you armed it) and **which beat** of the setup it is on. Read the beat, take the action:

[1]	approaching NN%	price still travelling to the zone	wait (watch the % climb)
[2]	TAGGED	price is inside the zone	get ready - a touch is not the entry
[3]	CONFIRMED	a fresh lower-TF swing formed off the zone	ENTER (auto fires here)
[x]	BROKEN	a full body closed through the zone	skip it - use the next zone down

```
BUY entry (demand IFVG sits BELOW price)

  1.15800  = = = TARGET (buy-side draw: ITH / PDH)     ^ 3 ride up
  1.15600  o  price now                                |
             |  1 price retraces DOWN toward the zone
             v
  1.15470  +----------------+  zone top
           |  DEMAND  IFVG  |   2 TAG -> swing UP = ENTER (beat 3)
  1.15400  +----------------+  zone bottom
  1.15380  x  stop (just below the zone - bot's structural stop)
```

```
SELL entry (supply IFVG sits ABOVE price) - the mirror

  1.16120  x  stop (just above the zone)
  1.16100  +----------------+  zone top
           |  SUPPLY  IFVG  |   2 TAG -> swing DOWN = ENTER (beat 3)
  1.16030  +----------------+  zone bottom
             ^  1 price rises UP toward the zone
  1.15900  o  price now
             |  3 ride down
             v
  1.15600  = = = TARGET (sell-side draw: ITL / PDL)
```

```
A zone that FAILS (beat [x] BROKEN) - do NOT trade it

  1.15470  +----------------+  zone top
           |  DEMAND  IFVG  |
  1.15400  +----------------+  zone bottom
             |  a full body CLOSES below the zone
             v
  1.15350  XX  zone SPENT -> skip it, drop to the next zone
```

Watch vs. auto-enter

- **/mm EURUSD buy** (or **sell**) - **WATCH** mode: the bot only alerts you ("price REACHED ...", "... IFVG BROKEN") and shows the beats. You place the entry yourself at beat [3] with **/test** (or **/pyramid** to add to a winner).
- **/mm EURUSD buy auto** - **AUTO** mode: you pre-permit **one** entry. When a zone hits beat [3] (price inside the IFVG AND a fresh LTF swing confirms) the bot enters it for you - own structural stop, nearest-liquidity target, your /lot size - then **disarms** (one shot). The header shows **[AUTO-ARMED]**.
- **/mm EURUSD off** - disarm. Everything expires at 00:00 UTC like all inputs.

> **KEY IDEA** Auto is one entry only and obeys every safety rule: **/halt** blocks it, and if a same-direction winner is already open it adds a pyramid leg instead of a second position (opposite - it skips). Re-arm with **/mm PAIR buy auto** to allow another.

7 - Session handovers: reading them, trading them

A **handover** is the gap between two sessions - most importantly **London** → **New York** (roughly 05:00-07:00 ET). This is where a lot of the day's best entries are made, so it's worth understanding well.

What happens at a handover

- London runs its Judas + delivery and sets the **day's USD direction** (a DXY-wide move).
- Into the handover, price **consolidates** - it pulls back, often to the session open, a 50% level, or an unfilled FVG. This is a fresh accumulation for NY.
- At the NY open, price **shifts structure** (a break on M5/M15) and either **continues** London's direction or starts a fresh NY Judas.

How the bot manages your open trade at the handover

At the 02:00 and 07:00 ET boundaries the bot runs a single check. It closes a position **only if BOTH**: (a) it is losing, AND (b) it is fighting the confirmed weekly bias. Anything winning, or aligned with the week, is left to run. So a good London trade already carries into New York by default.

> **TIP** Use **/hold EURUSD** to exempt a pair from that close entirely - it then runs into NY (and NY-AM into the afternoon) on its stop, target and trailing only. That is the instruction for "leave my London trade open and let it run."

How to trade the handover for entries

A simple, repeatable playbook that lines up with what the bot already does:

- **Read London's direction.** Which way did the dollar go after the London Judas? That is the day's bias.
- **Mark the handover consolidation.** Note the high and low price coils into over 05:00-07:00 ET - the buy-side (above) and sell-side (below).
- **Feed those to the bot.** Set **/levels** with sell-side below (for a long continuation) or buy-side above (for a short), and **/bias** to London's direction so the bot only hunts the continuation.
- **Let the sweep confirm the entry.** At NY open price typically sweeps the handover range once (a small Judas) then continues - the bot enters the retrace into the FVG, targeting the far side.
- **/hold the London trade** if you'd rather ride the original position through than take a fresh NY entry.

> **KEY IDEA** The continuation "looks like a small Judas swing but is really a continuation" - a sweep of the handover range in the direction of the London/DXY move. That is the single most reliable NY-session entry, and your /levels + /bias point the bot straight at it.

8 - Liquidity levels: your buy-side / sell-side inputs

This is how you hand the bot the levels you're watching. In ICT terms:

Buy-side liquidity	ABOVE price	Resting buy stops (shorts' stops, breakout buys)	Old highs, PDH, session high, equal highs, round numbers
Sell-side liquidity	BELOW price	Resting sell stops (longs' stops, breakdown sells)	Old lows, PDL, session low, equal lows, round numbers

How to add them

```
/levels EURUSD buy 1.0975 1.0990 sell 1.0900 1.0880
```

buy = the pools above price; **sell** = the pools below. List as many as you like on each side, space-separated. They apply to that pair for the rest of the UTC day and expire overnight.

What the bot does with them - full manual AMD

Your two sides define the day's range, and the bot trades the AMD cycle across them:

- Price sweeps the **sell-side** and reclaims → the bot hunts **LONG**, targeting the **buy-side**.
- Price sweeps the **buy-side** and drops back → the bot hunts **SHORT**, targeting the **sell-side**.
- Neither side swept yet → the bot **waits** (manipulation hasn't happened).

So the same levels do two jobs at once: **entries** (the sweep of one side arms the trade and its direction) and **exits** (the opposite side becomes the take-profit draw). The bot's own structure + FVG entry must still trigger - your levels decide **which way** and **where to**, the engine decides **whether the setup is there**.

> **TIP** Put your sell-side where you expect stops to be run BEFORE a long (just under an obvious low / round number), and your buy-side at the draw you expect price to deliver to. The bot will wait for the sweep, then aim for your target.

9 - Targets & exits: where the bot takes profit

Left on auto, the bot chooses the **nearest qualifying** institutional draw as its target - never a far moonshot. Candidate draws, scored by how many agree at one price (confluence):

- Fibonacci extensions (the workhorse), fair-value-gap and order-block midpoints,
- Previous day / week high & low (PDH/PDL, PWH/PWL), intermediate swing highs/lows,
- Equal highs/lows and round numbers.

Minimum target distance is **30 pips**. When you set **/levels**, the opposite side replaces the auto target (if it's a valid, far-enough draw).

Protecting the trade - the trailing ladder

+10 pips	Break-even (entry)
+20 pips	Locked at +10 pips
+40 / +60 / +80 ...	Milestone trail: +30 / +50 / +70 ... (locks every +20)

Short-target trades exit at the take-profit before any milestone fires. Long-running trades (into distant draws) ratchet the stop up every 20 pips so a late reversal still banks most of the move.

> **NOTE** The take-profit is the END of the AMD delivery cycle. The bot exits into the draw rather than holding for more - testing showed holding past it gives back profit. The far pools are the NEXT cycle's job.

Structure trail - riding the swings (optional)

On top of the automatic ladder you can trail the stop by **market structure** from Telegram with **/trail** - the stop follows the latest **intact fractal swing** on a lower timeframe, keeping a pip buffer you choose. It only ever tightens, and stacks with the ladder above (whichever stop is tighter wins).

Timeframe	m15 / m5 / m1	How fine the swings it follows are (m1 = tightest).
Tier	st = STH/STL, it = ITH/ITL	Short-term locks faster; intermediate is looser, fewer stop-outs.
Buffer	a pip number (default 2)	How far beyond the swing the stop sits.

For a **long** the stop trails under the latest intact low (STL/ITL minus buffer); for a **short**, above the latest intact high (STH/ITH plus buffer) - the bot picks the correct side. Example: `/trail EURUSD m5 st 3` rides the M5 short-term structure 3 pips behind each swing; `/trail EURUSD off` stops it.

10 - Talking to the algorithm: the Telegram manual

You control the bot by replying to its messages in Telegram. It only obeys **your** chat - no one else can steer it. Every command is acknowledged so you always see what registered. Send **/help** any time for the list.

Session templates - you get one at every session start

At the top of each session the bot messages you a template to reply to (**LONDON** ~02:00 ET, **NEW YORK AM** ~07:00 ET, and **NEW YORK PM** if enabled). The NY templates also list what's already open, so you can decide whether to **/hold** it across the handover.

Ask the bot (read anytime - no effect on trading)

/brief	Full session brief: account + structure + open trades + your plan. The same rich summary the bot sends at each session start.
/read [EURUSD]	Market-structure template per pair: price, H4/H1/M15 structure, ITH/ITL draws, directional lean %, the bot's intended trade + scenario, plus any armed MM IFVG beats. /markets = all at a glance.
/positions	Open trades broken out PER LEG (e.g. 2 x 0.02 = 0.04), each with entry, live pips, SL and ticket - plus P&L, % to target, model, TP idea + SL basis (survives restarts).
/account	Equity, day P&L, drawdown, halt state (also /equity).
/dxy - /session - /news	Dollar index now - which killzone & if entries are allowed - next high-impact news.
/whoami	Your chat id + access level.

Plan & control

/lot 0.02	Day lot for all pairs (/lot GBPUSD 0.03 for one). Base lot - the sizing multipliers still stack.
/bias EURUSD long	Hunt one direction only (long | short | both). A filter: the bot still needs its own setup.
/levels EURUSD buy 1.0975 sell 1.0900	Your buy-side / sell-side liquidity -> full manual AMD (Section 8).
/mm EURUSD buy [auto]	Arm the Market Maker IFVG model: watch-only, or 'auto' to pre-permit one entry (Section 6, Model 3). /mm EURUSD off disarms.
/hold EURUSD	Let this pair run across the session handover (also /hold all). /release EURUSD undoes it.
/trail EURUSD m5 st 3	Trail the stop behind the latest intact swing: tf m15|m5|m1, tier st (STH/STL) or it (ITH/ITL), pip buffer. Only tightens. /trail EURUSD off.
/test EURUSD long [0.05]	Open a trade NOW (also short; /buy /sell) with the bot's structural stop + 2R target, at an optional lot size.
/pyramid EURUSD [1.1600]	Add a leg to a WINNING position - same TP, or a level you give.
/sl EURUSD 1.1555 - /be EURUSD	Move the stop to a price (or /sl EURUSD 2 ... for one leg); /be moves it to break-even.
/close EURUSD [2]	Close the whole position, or just leg 2 (/close all flattens everything; /flat is the shortcut).
/halt - /resume	Stop ALL new entries + pyramid adds (open trades keep running) - then re-enable.
/status - /auto EURUSD - /clear - /help	Echo today's plan - revert one pair - revert all - command list.

TIP To go flat and stay out: **/close all** then **/halt**. To stop new trades but let current winners run: just **/halt**.

Sharing the bot with a partner

Your partner opens the **same** bot (share the link) and texts it - you do NOT create a second bot. What they can do depends on how you list their Telegram chat id (they get theirs from @userinfobot, or /whoami once they can read):

- **Admin** (full control, trades like you) - add their id to `TELEGRAM_ADMIN_IDS` in live.env.
- **Viewer** (read-only + alerts) - add it to `TELEGRAM_VIEWER_IDS`.
- **Open read-only** for anyone with the link - set `TELEGRAM_OPEN_VIEW=1` (trading still needs an admin id).

NOTE Easiest way to add someone: `scripts\add_access.ps1 -Id <id> -Role admin|viewer` on the VM, then restart the bot so it re-reads live.env. Trading control can never be open - it moves real money.

11 - Risk & circuit breakers

Sizing follows equity tiers (it grows as the account grows). A day lot you set with **/lot** becomes the base; the conviction multipliers (2x/3x on a full higher-timeframe draw, 1.25x on high-confluence / CRT / prior-day-liquidity sweeps) still stack on top - but only above R3,000 equity, so they stay dormant while the account is small.

Four automatic breakers protect the account. They run regardless of any semi-auto input:

Max drawdown halt	-15% from peak equity	Pause trading 10 days
Daily loss cap	-6% of the day's opening equity	No new entries rest of day
Consecutive losses	5 losses in a row	Pause rest of day
Session kill switch	-10% from session open	Close all positions, halt the day

12 - A day in the life

A worked example of driving the bot through a full day.

07:55 ET - the LONDON template already fired; you reply

```
/lot 0.02
/bias EURUSD long
/levels EURUSD buy 1.0975 sell 1.0900 1.0880
/hold EURUSD
```

The bot acks each line. It will trade EURUSD **long only**, and only **after** price sweeps 1.0900 / 1.0880 and reclaims - aiming at 1.0975 - and only if its own structure + FVG entry fires. GBPUSD and NZDUSD keep trading fully automatically.

08:30 ET - TRADE OPENED alert

The bot messages you the entry, stop, target, scenario and model. Your London long is on. You watch from your phone; no need to sit at the screen.

07:00 ET next block - NEW YORK AM template

"Open now: EURUSD - holding: EURUSD." Because you set /hold, the London long is running into New York instead of being closed at the handover. You could add **/bias GBPUSD short** for the NY session, or **/release EURUSD** if you've changed your mind. If it's gone far enough, **/close EURUSD** banks it.

Anytime - things go wrong

News spike, or you just want out: **/close all** flattens everything and **/halt** stops new entries until you **/resume**.

13 - Go-live checklist & quick reference

Go-live checklist (do not skip)

- Bootstrap the VM, install MT5, log into your Exness **DEMO** account.
- Smoke test passes (every symbol resolves, DXY reads ~90-115).
- Semi-auto self-test passes: `python -m live.test_semi_auto`.

- Run on DEMO for at least 2 weeks; reconcile a few fills against data\live.log.
- Confirm a /hold across a real handover behaves as expected on demo.
- Only then switch live.env to the funded account and start small.

Quick reference card

/lot 0.02	day lot (base; multipliers stack)
/bias EURUSD long|short|both	direction filter
/levels EURUSD buy ... sell ...	manual-AMD liquidity (sweep -> target)
/mm EURUSD buy|sell [auto]|off	Market Maker IFVG model (watch / auto-enter)
/test EURUSD long [0.05] | /pyramid EURUSD	open now / add to a winner
/sl EURUSD 1.1555 | /be EURUSD	move stop to price / break-even
/trail EURUSD m15|m5|m1 st|it [pips]	trail stop behind the latest intact swing
/hold EURUSD | /release EURUSD	run across the handover / undo
/close EURUSD [leg] | /close all	close position / one leg / flatten
/halt | /resume	pause / re-enable new entries + adds
/status | /auto EURUSD | /clear	review / revert one / revert all

> **IMPORTANT** The strategy is validated in backtest, not yet proven live. This manual gets you operating it correctly; the demo-first discipline is what keeps the R500 safe while live behaviour is confirmed.

Generated from the shipped engine. Re-run `python scripts/build_manual_pdf.py` after strategy changes to refresh.